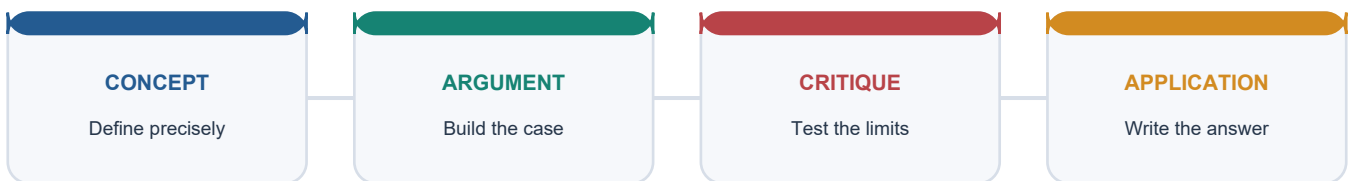


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Diverse Perspectives on the State - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Diverse Perspectives on the State - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 13 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Organic theory**?

- A. the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).
- B. they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260).
- C. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279).
- D. Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Organic theory.
- **B:** B Attaches to J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver, not Organic theory.
- **C:** C Attaches to Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom, not Organic theory.
- **D:** D Attaches to Burke and Hegel, not Organic theory.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Organic theory by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Social-contract theory**?

- A. the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222).
- B. the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).
- C. the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).
- D. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Aristotle, not Social-contract theory.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Social-contract theory.
- **C:** C Attaches to Laissez-faire individualism, not Social-contract theory.
- **D:** D Attaches to Communitarian perspective, not Social-contract theory.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Social-contract theory by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Laissez-faire individualism**?

- A. the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).
- B. they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244).
- C. the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).
- D. the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Social-contract theory, not Laissez-faire individualism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick, not Laissez-faire individualism.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Laissez-faire individualism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Post-colonial perspective, not Laissez-faire individualism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Laissez-faire individualism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Welfare / positive liberal state**?

- A. he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277).
- B. they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260).
- C. the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).
- D. the state should create conditions for moral freedom and social welfare, especially for vulnerable sections (PDF pp.245-260).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Gandhi, not Welfare / positive liberal state.
- **B:** B Attaches to J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver, not Welfare / positive liberal state.
- **C:** C Attaches to Organic theory, not Welfare / positive liberal state.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Welfare / positive liberal state.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Welfare / positive liberal state by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Class theory of the state**?

- A. the state arises with private property and class division and serves dominant-class power (PDF pp.261-266).
- B. Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222).
- C. they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279).
- D. the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Class theory of the state.
- **B:** B Attaches to Burke and Hegel, not Class theory of the state.
- **C:** C Attaches to Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom, not Class theory of the state.
- **D:** D Attaches to Organic theory, not Class theory of the state.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Class theory of the state by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Communitarian perspective**?

- A. the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222).
- B. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).
- C. the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF pp.278-279).
- D. the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Aristotle, not Communitarian perspective.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Communitarian perspective.
- **C:** C Attaches to Pluralist perspective, not Communitarian perspective.
- **D:** D Attaches to Gandhian perspective, not Communitarian perspective.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Communitarian perspective by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Post-colonial perspective**?

- A. they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244).
- B. the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).
- C. the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273).
- D. the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick, not Post-colonial perspective.
- **B:** B Attaches to Laissez-faire individualism, not Post-colonial perspective.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Post-colonial perspective.
- **D:** D Attaches to Social-contract theory, not Post-colonial perspective.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Post-colonial perspective by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Gandhian perspective**?

- A. the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222).
- B. the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).
- C. the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF pp.278-279).
- D. the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Aristotle, not Gandhian perspective.
- **B:** B Attaches to Communitarian perspective, not Gandhian perspective.
- **C:** C Attaches to Pluralist perspective, not Gandhian perspective.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Gandhian perspective.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Gandhian perspective by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Feminist perspective - the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and.
- B. State above society vs state within society - they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property.
- C. Post-colonial perspective - organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist.
- D. Laissez-faire individualism - the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: Feminist perspective is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: State above society vs state within society is recorded with organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Post-colonial perspective is recorded with the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Laissez-faire individualism is recorded with the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Feminist perspective; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Communitarian perspective - the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).
- B. Pluralist perspective - the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF).
- C. Gandhian perspective - they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).
- D. Aristotle - he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Communitarian perspective is recorded with the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).
- **B:** B Faithful pairing: Pluralist perspective is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Gandhian perspective is recorded with the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277).
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Aristotle is recorded with the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Pluralist perspective; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Post-colonial perspective - the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF).
- B. State above society vs state within society - the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order.
- C. Ethical institution vs instrument - organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist.
- D. Feminist perspective - they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Post-colonial perspective is recorded with the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273).
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: State above society vs state within society is recorded with organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists, pluralists and MacIver-style liberals distinguish them sharply (PDF pp.224-225, 258-260, 261-266).
- **C:** C Exact pair: Ethical institution vs instrument is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Feminist perspective is recorded with the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and institutions (PDF pp.277-278).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Ethical institution vs instrument; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau - the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and.
- B. Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed - organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists.
- C. Ethical institution vs instrument - the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence.
- D. Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule - laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau is recorded with all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance rights, and Rousseau locates sovereignty in the people as a collective whole (PDF pp.227-236).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed is recorded with Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Ethical institution vs instrument is recorded with organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279).
- **D:** D Exact pair: Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. State above society vs state within society - organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists.
- B. Feminist perspective - the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).
- C. Ethical institution vs instrument - they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244).
- D. Post-colonial perspective - the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Kept where the source puts it: State above society vs state within society is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Feminist perspective is recorded with the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how patriarchy is embedded in policy and institutions (PDF pp.277-278).
- **C:** C Not this pair: Ethical institution vs instrument is recorded with organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Post-colonial perspective is recorded with the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to State above society vs state within society; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Communitarian perspective - the state is not the sole centre of power but should coordinate and arbitrate among multiple associations and interests (PDF pp.278-279).
- B. Aristotle - the state exists for life and continues for the good life; man is intelligible as a political being only within the polis (PDF pp.221-222).
- C. Gandhian perspective - the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).
- D. Social-contract theory - they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Communitarian perspective is recorded with the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).
- **B:** B Correct attachment: Aristotle is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Gandhian perspective is recorded with the state is a coercive and centralized machine, morally inferior to self-rule, self-discipline and decentralized swaraj (PDF pp.273-277).
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Social-contract theory is recorded with the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Aristotle; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Organic theory - the state should create conditions for moral freedom and social welfare, especially for vulnerable sections (PDF pp.245-260).
- B. Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom - the state arises with private property and class division and serves dominant-class power (PDF pp.261-266).
- C. Burke and Hegel - Burke stresses historical growth; Hegel heightens the state's ethical image to an almost sacred level (PDF p.222).
- D. J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver - he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Organic theory is recorded with the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom is recorded with they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279).
- **C:** C Records the association: Burke and Hegel is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver is recorded with they revise liberalism toward social welfare, moral freedom, service-state and democratic regulation (PDF pp.249-260).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Burke and Hegel; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Ethical institution vs instrument - the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence.
- B. Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed - organic theory tends to blur state and society, while Marxists.
- C. Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule - the state regulates power in both public and intimate life; justice requires exposing how.
- D. Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau - all use contract, but Hobbes creates security through absolute sovereignty, Locke creates constitutional government and resistance.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Ethical institution vs instrument is recorded with organic/idealist thought treats the state as ethically exalted, while liberal, Marxist, Gandhian and pluralist views treat it more instrumentally (PDF pp.222-225, 236-279).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed is recorded with Miliband explains capitalist state service through personnel, direct economic leverage and officials' vested interests; Poulantzas explains it through structural dependence combined with relative autonomy.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Negative liberty vs positive liberty vs moral self-rule is recorded with laissez-faire liberalism emphasizes non-interference, welfare liberalism emphasizes enabling conditions, and Gandhi ties freedom to self-discipline and resistance to domination (PDF pp.236-260, 275-277).
- **D:** D Source-exact: Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick** is associated with: they represent different forms of liberal-individualist or libertarian insistence on property, contract and limited government (PDF pp.237-244).
2. **Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed** is associated with: they build pluralist arguments around multiple centres of power, associational life and polyarchy (PDF pp.278-279).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Adam Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer, Nozick does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver** is associated with: they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).
2. **MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor** is associated with: they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski, MacIver does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas** is associated with: they see the state through class domination, though neo-Marxists debate how far the state is relatively autonomous (PDF pp.261-267). Gramsci was the first neo-Marxist to concede relative autonomy of the state, distinguishing political society (which relies on force/direct domination through "juridical" government) from civil society (which relies on consent/"hegemony" through family, school and church) (PDF p.266).
2. **Gandhi** is associated with: he treats the state as coercive, upholds swaraj and trusteeship, and prefers moral self-rule to centralized power (PDF pp.273-277).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Marx, Engels, Lenin, Gramsci, Miliband, Poulantzas does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed** is associated with: both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points.
2. **Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged** is associated with: the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Miliband vs Poulantzas - the instrumentalist/structuralist debate, reconstructed does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor** is associated with: they criticize the atomistic liberal self and recover community, embeddedness and differentiated spheres of justice (PDF pp.267-270).
2. **Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom** is associated with: the state should create conditions for moral freedom and social welfare, especially for vulnerable sections (PDF pp.245-260).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with MacIntyre, Sandel, Walzer, Taylor does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Gandhi** is associated with: the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).
2. **Organic theory** is associated with: the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Gandhi does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged** is associated with: both expose how state power is gendered, but from different entry points.
2. **Social-contract theory** is associated with: the state is an artificial device created by agreement to remedy defects of the state of nature and secure order or liberty (PDF pp.226-236).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Kate Millett and Zillah Eisenstein - distinguished, not merged does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom** is associated with: the state is a necessary evil whose task is mainly protection, contract-enforcement and law and order, not economic regulation (PDF pp.236-244).
2. **Laissez-faire individualism** is associated with: the post-colonial state must be understood through colonial domination, neo-colonial dependence, nation-building and state-building (PDF pp.270-273).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Organic theory simply means patriotism.**"?

- A. In Gauba it is a strong claim that the state is natural, ethically prior and superior to the individual (PDF pp.221-223).
- B. Hobbes does not; Locke does; Rousseau is popular-sovereign but still absolutist in an important sense (PDF pp.230-234).
- C. Gauba's feminist section insists that domination extends into intimate relations and that the personal itself is political (PDF p.277).
- D. Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: In Gauba it is a strong claim that the state is natural, ethically prior and superior to the individual (PDF pp.221-223).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "All contract theorists defend limited government.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Feminism studies only representation in parliament.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Organic theory means the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Organic theory simply means patriotism.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"All contract theorists defend limited government."**?

- A. In Gauba it is a strong claim that the state is natural, ethically prior and superior to the individual (PDF pp.221-223).
- B. Hobbes does not; Locke does; Rousseau is popular-sovereign but still absolutist in an important sense (PDF pp.230-234).
- C. Gauba's feminist section insists that domination extends into intimate relations and that the personal itself is political (PDF p.277).
- D. Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Organic theory simply means patriotism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Hobbes does not; Locke does; Rousseau is popular-sovereign but still absolutist in an important sense (PDF pp.230-234).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Feminism studies only representation in parliament.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Organic theory means the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "All contract theorists defend limited government.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Liberalism always means minimal state."**?

- A. Gauba's feminist section insists that domination extends into intimate relations and that the personal itself is political.
- B. Hobbes does not; Locke does; Rousseau is popular-sovereign but still absolutist in an important sense (PDF pp.230-234).
- C. Gauba clearly distinguishes laissez-faire from welfare or positive liberalism (PDF pp.243-260).
- D. In Gauba it is a strong claim that the state is natural, ethically prior and superior to the individual (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Feminism studies only representation in parliament.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "All contract theorists defend limited government.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba clearly distinguishes laissez-faire from welfare or positive liberalism (PDF pp.243-260).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Organic theory simply means patriotism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Liberalism always means minimal state.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Gandhi was just another anarchist.**"?

- A. In Gauba it is a strong claim that the state is natural, ethically prior and superior to the individual (PDF pp.221-223); the other dimensions would remain secondary under this reading.
- B. Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).
- C. Gauba's feminist section insists that domination extends into intimate relations and that the personal itself is political (PDF p.277).
- D. Gandhi shares suspicion of coercive authority, but grounds his position in ahimsa, religion, swaraj and satyagraha.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "'Organic theory simply means patriotism.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Organic theory means the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "'Feminism studies only representation in parliament.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gandhi shares suspicion of coercive authority, but grounds his position in ahimsa, religion, swaraj and satyagraha, not in the same premises as Bakunin or Kropotkin (PDF pp.274-277).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Gandhi was just another anarchist.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Feminism studies only representation in parliament.**"?

- A. Gauba's feminist section insists that domination extends into intimate relations and that the personal itself is political (PDF p.277).
- B. Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).
- C. In Gauba it is a strong claim that the state is natural, ethically prior and superior to the individual (PDF pp.221-223).
- D. Hobbes does not; Locke does; Rousseau is popular-sovereign but still absolutist in an important sense (PDF pp.230-234).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's feminist section insists that domination extends into intimate relations and that the personal itself is political (PDF p.277).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Organic theory means the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "'Organic theory simply means patriotism.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "'All contract theorists defend limited government.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Feminism studies only representation in parliament.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Miliband and Poulantzas say the same thing about the capitalist state."**?

- A. Millett's entry point is the personal/intimate sphere and "power-structured relationships"; Eisenstein's is the liberal state's claimed neutrality and its.
- B. Miliband's instrumentalism (state = direct tool of capitalist class via personnel/economic power/vested interest) is explicitly rejected by Poulantzas's.
- C. Gandhi shares suspicion of coercive authority, but grounds his position in ahimsa, religion, swaraj and satyagraha.
- D. Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Millett and Eisenstein make the identical feminist argument about the state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Miliband's instrumentalism (state = direct tool of capitalist class via personnel/economic power/vested interest) is explicitly rejected by Poulantzas's structuralism (relative autonomy of the state, legitimacy through "the people," state as arena of class struggle); Gauba himself flags the risk that Poulantzas's autonomy thesis can drift away from core Marxism (PDF p.266).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Gandhi was just another anarchist.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Organic theory means the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Miliband and Poulantzas say the same thing about, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Millett and Eisenstein make the identical feminist argument about the state."**?

- A. Gandhi shares suspicion of coercive authority, but grounds his position in ahimsa, religion, swaraj and satyagraha.
- B. Miliband's instrumentalism (state = direct tool of capitalist class via personnel/economic power/vested interest) is explicitly rejected by Poulantzas's.
- C. Millett's entry point is the personal/intimate sphere and "power-structured relationships"; Eisenstein's is the liberal state's claimed neutrality and its.
- D. Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Gandhi was just another anarchist.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Miliband and Poulantzas say the same thing about the capitalist state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Millett's entry point is the personal/intimate sphere and "power-structured relationships"; Eisenstein's is the liberal state's claimed neutrality and its socialist-feminist critique of capitalist welfare policy - distinct emphases within one broader feminist perspective (PDF pp.277-278).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Organic theory means the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Millett and Eisenstein make the identical feminist, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Organic theory means the self is socially embedded, so political order must attend not only to rights but also to shared values and community (PDF pp.267-270).**?

- A. In Gauba it is a strong claim that the state is natural, ethically prior and superior to the individual (PDF pp.221-223).
- B. Gauba's feminist section insists that domination extends into intimate relations and that the personal itself is political (PDF p.277).
- C. Hobbes does not; Locke does; Rousseau is popular-sovereign but still absolutist in an important sense (PDF pp.230-234).
- D. Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Organic theory simply means patriotism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Feminism studies only representation in parliament.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "All contract theorists defend limited government.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Organic theory means the state is like an organism; individuals are like its organs, and their worth depends on the whole (PDF pp.221-223).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Organic theory means the self is socially embedded,, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Compare the organic and social-contract perspectives on the origin and purpose of the state. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of the organic and social-contract perspectives on the origin and purpose of the state in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Organic, Core and Aristotle, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Organic theory explains embedded political membership but risks absorption, while contract theory makes authority answerable to consent but relies on simplified origin stories and unequal imagined contractors.

Model answer (137 words):

Introduction: Organic and social-contract theories differ fundamentally over whether the state is a natural ethical whole or an artificial institution created by individuals. Core analysis: Aristotle treats political association as the completion of human sociability and the condition of the good life; Burke stresses historical growth, while Hegel elevates the state's ethical significance. Contract thinkers begin from individuals outside political authority. Hobbes creates an absolute sovereign for security, Locke a limited trust for rights, and Rousseau a popular sovereign that converts natural into civil freedom. Contract thus makes legitimacy depend on an account of authorisation and purpose rather than organic priority. Neither origin story alone settles legitimate state action. Conclusion: Organic theory explains embedded political membership but risks absorption, while contract theory makes authority answerable to consent but relies on simplified origin stories and unequal imagined contractors.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Organic, Core and Aristotle), converts that evidence into analysis of the organic and social-contract perspectives on the origin and purpose of the state, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Organic theory explains embedded political membership but risks absorption, while contract theory makes authority answerable to consent but relies on simplified origin stories and unequal imagined contractors. At 137 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish the laissez-faire state from the welfare or positive-liberal state. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of the laissez-faire state from the welfare or positive-liberal state in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Laissez-faire, Core and Smith, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The welfare state corrects minimal liberalism by treating enabling conditions as part of freedom, though it remains contested whether regulation reforms or stabilises deeper structures of inequality.

Model answer (141 words):

Introduction: Laissez-faire and welfare liberalism share individual freedom as an end but disagree about whether non-interference is sufficient to make freedom real. Core analysis: The laissez-faire state protects life, property, contract, justice and defence while treating wider intervention as a threat to liberty and spontaneous market order. Smith, Bentham, James Mill, Spencer and Nozick supply different rationales for limited government. Welfare or positive liberalism emerges from the harms of industrial capitalism. J.S. Mill, T.H. Green, Hobhouse, Laski and MacIver argue that education, health, labour protection and social security can remove obstacles to self-development. The defensible distinction is negative protection versus publicly secured enabling conditions, not liberty versus coercion in the abstract. Conclusion: The welfare state corrects minimal liberalism by treating enabling conditions as part of freedom, though it remains contested whether regulation reforms or stabilises deeper structures of inequality.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Laissez-faire, Core and Smith), converts that evidence into analysis of the laissez-faire state from the welfare or positive-liberal state, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The welfare state corrects minimal liberalism by treating enabling conditions as part of freedom, though it remains contested

whether regulation reforms or stabilises deeper structures of inequality. At 141 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Critically examine the Marxist theory of the state with reference to Miliband and Poulantzas. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *critically examine* requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of *examine the Marxist theory of the state with reference to Miliband and Poulantzas* in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Marxist, Marxism and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Neo-Marxist debate replaces a crude instrument model with bounded relative autonomy: the state may mediate among interests while remaining structurally tied to the reproduction of capitalist power.

Model answer (147 words):

Introduction: Marxist theory interprets the state through class power, while neo-Marxism disputes direct capture versus structural service. Core analysis: Classical Marxism links the state to private property, class division and coercive protection of dominant interests. Miliband's instrumentalism identifies shared elite backgrounds, capital's direct economic leverage and officials' stake in the existing system. Poulantzas replies that the capitalist state requires relative autonomy: it must organise competing fractions, claim to represent the people and secure long-term system stability rather than obey individual capitalists mechanically. The state is therefore an arena of class struggle as well as an institution functionally related to capitalism. The strongest position treats autonomy as real, institutionally variable and bounded by structural dependence on accumulation and social order. Conclusion: Neo-Marxist debate replaces a crude instrument model with bounded relative autonomy: the state may mediate among interests while remaining structurally tied to the reproduction of capitalist power.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *critically examine* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Marxist, Marxism and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of *examine the Marxist theory of the state with reference to Miliband and Poulantzas*, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Neo-Marxist debate replaces a crude instrument model with bounded relative autonomy: the state may mediate among interests while remaining structurally tied to the reproduction of capitalist power. At 147 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Gandhian and pluralist criticisms of centralised state power. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *compare* requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of *gandhian and pluralist criticisms of centralised state power* in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Gandhian, Core and Gandhi, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Both disperse authority, but Gandhi grounds decentralisation in moral self-rule and non-violence, whereas pluralism institutionalises competing associations under a residual coordinating public order.

Model answer (202 words):

Introduction: Gandhian and pluralist theories both challenge the monopolistic state, but they rest on different moral anthropologies and institutional remedies. Core analysis: Gandhi treats the centralised state as a soulless coercive machine and locates freedom in swaraj, self-discipline, non-violence, trusteeship and village-centred moral reconstruction. Pluralists such as Duguit, Laski, MacIver, Dahl and Lindblom emphasise multiple associations and centres of power. They seek freedom of association, dispersed bargaining and a state that coordinates or arbitrates rather than absorbs society. Gandhi points beyond dependence on state machinery; pluralism redesigns authority within modern institutional democracy. Further development: Their accounts of obedience also differ. Gandhi forms an ethical subject capable of resisting unjust authority through disciplined non-violence; pluralism organises enduring interests through representation and checks. A defensible synthesis protects decentralised association while retaining safeguards against local oppression, unequal resources and violent conflict. Critical evaluation: Gandhian decentralisation may be difficult to scale and can romanticise community, while pluralism can overlook unequal resources and domination within groups. Both require rights and coordination if dispersal is to produce freedom rather than local hierarchy or stalemate. Conclusion: Both disperse authority, but Gandhi grounds decentralisation in moral

self-rule and non-violence, whereas pluralism institutionalises competing associations under a residual coordinating public order.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Gandhian, Core and Gandhi), converts that evidence into analysis of gandhian and pluralist criticisms of centralised state power, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Both disperse authority, but Gandhi grounds decentralisation in moral self-rule and non-violence, whereas pluralism institutionalises competing associations under a residual coordinating public order. At 202 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate diverse perspectives on the state through origin, purpose, liberty, inequality, civil society and route to change. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of diverse perspectives on the state through origin, purpose, liberty, inequality, civil society and route to change in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Diverse, Core and Organic, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that disciplined comparison reveals which dimension each theory illuminates and where its universalisation obscures coercion, dependence or legitimate common action.

Model answer (236 words):

Introduction: Diverse state theories become analytically comparable only when each is tested through the same dimensions rather than narrated as an unrelated list. Core analysis: Organic theory makes the state natural and ethical; contract theory makes it artificial and authorised; laissez-faire protects negative liberty, while welfare liberalism secures enabling conditions. Their purposes diverge across good life, security and rights, market order, welfare, class rule, post-colonial state-building, swaraj and pluralist coordination. On inequality, organic theory may naturalise hierarchy, laissez-faire accepts market outcomes, and welfare, Marxist, post-colonial and feminist views expose social structures that produce unequal power. On civil society, organic theory tends to absorb it, liberals protect it, Gramsci treats it as a site of hegemony, Gandhi privileges moral community and pluralists make associations a democratic restraint. Routes to change range from cultivation and constitutional reform to revolution, decolonisation, non-violence and associational redistribution. Further development: The 1-2 July 2026 National Conference on e-Governance provides a limited current illustration of competing state images. Its emphasis on AI-enabled, data-driven and secure digital governance presents the state as a service and capacity-building institution rather than only a sovereign commander. A reasoned verdict should identify the actual problem in the question-order, freedom, class, coloniality, gender or coordination-and combine insights without erasing doctrinal disagreement. Conclusion: No single image exhausts the state; disciplined comparison reveals which dimension each theory illuminates and where its universalisation obscures coercion, dependence or legitimate common action.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Diverse, Core and Organic), converts that evidence into analysis of diverse perspectives on the state through origin, purpose, liberty, inequality, civil society and route to change, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that disciplined comparison reveals which dimension each theory illuminates and where its universalisation obscures coercion, dependence or legitimate common action. At 236 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: How do feminist and post-colonial perspectives widen classical state theory? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive how requires the answer to state the mechanism step by step and show what each step produces. Fix the boundary of do feminist and post-colonial perspectives widen classical state theory in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Feminist, Core and Post-colonial, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that critical evaluation: Neither perspective simply adds another disadvantaged group.

Model answer (249 words):

Introduction: Feminist and post-colonial perspectives widen state theory by challenging the supposedly universal subject and history presupposed by classical accounts. Core analysis: Post-colonial analysis shows that newly

independent states inherit borders, bureaucracies, elites and economic dependencies formed under empire. Formal sovereignty must therefore be joined to nation-building, state-building and decolonisation of institutions and values. Feminist theory shows that the public state is constituted through power in family, sexuality, labour and welfare. Kate Millett expands politics into intimate domination, while Zillah Eisenstein attacks the liberal state's claimed neutrality and its dependence on gendered paid and unpaid labour. Further development: The perspectives intersect without becoming identical. Colonial rule often reorganised family law, labour, land and bureaucracy through gendered categories, while post-colonial development can rely on women's unpaid care and inherited administrative hierarchies. Feminist analysis prevents national liberation from being treated as sufficient emancipation; post-colonial analysis prevents gender theory from assuming a universal Western institutional history. Their combined lesson is intersectional and historical: state power is located in public institutions, intimate relations and transnational structures at once. Critical evaluation: Neither perspective simply adds another disadvantaged group. Each changes the concept of power and legitimacy: the state must answer for the histories and private structures through which citizens become unequal. Their internal diversity also prevents one post-colonial or feminist state model from becoming final. Conclusion: Feminist and post-colonial theories expose the hidden histories and social locations of supposedly universal state categories, extending legitimacy from formal public authority to gendered, colonial and institutional power.

Why this earns marks: it obeys how instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Feminist, Core and Post-colonial), converts that evidence into analysis of do feminist and post-colonial perspectives widen classical state theory, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that critical evaluation: Neither perspective simply adds another disadvantaged group. At 249 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
